

Oravia

Grammar

0. Glossary of common terms

Vocabulary - the bulk of the language, ~800 words, almost all composed of (sub)cluster + root (e.g., ANE + LEM = remain).

Cluster - the first two letters and/or first syllable of a word, which indicates its noun class. There are 48 clusters. Not all words belong to a cluster but almost all do (e.g., AN = movement). The exceptions are typically pronouns, prepositions, and numbers.

Subcluster - subdivision of a cluster, typically indicated by the third letter. Clusters have between 0-4 subclusters (e.g., ANE = static movement. There is also ANI = movement toward, and ANO = movement away).

Root - typically the rest of the word after subtracting the (sub)cluster, creating cross-cluster associations (e.g., LEM = remain, like BEILEM = vehicle + remain = station).

Building Blocks - all the clusters, subclusters and roots, which form the syllable-meaning associations of Oravia (e.g., ANE = static movement, LEM = remain, BEI = vehicle).

Marker - they indicate the syntactic role of a word in a sentence by introducing blocks (e.g., [SUBJECT my mom and I] [VERB give freely] [DIRECT OBJECT homemade food] [INDIRECT OBJECT to people in need]). The markers are a (subject), i (verb), e (direct object), u (indirect object, to, for), o (emphasis).

Compounds - two or more words indicating together a concept (e.g., yedia yaltana miau = striped-big-cat = tiger). When a preceding word is a compound rather than an adjective, you attach -a to the end of it.

Hyphenated - two words joined together for flavor or fine-grained meaning (e.g., ilofun-vardei = to hesitant-look).

Part I — Language Structure

1. Typological Overview

Oravia is an analytic language. Words do not change shape to mark agreement, gender, number, or tense. The same word can function as a noun, verb, adjective, or adverb depending on context. All grammatical relationships are signaled by small marker words, not by modifying the words themselves.

Key features:

- No articles (no "the" or "a")
- No grammatical gender (except optional suffixes)
- No plural forms (except for personal pronouns)
- No obligatory tense marking, aspect is optional and always explicit
- Flexible word order at the sentence level: markers determine role
- Words are built from sounds that carry consistent meanings (syllable-meaning associations)

2. Phonology

2.1 Consonants

The consonants are: B C D F G H J L M N P R S T V W Y

All pronounced as expected in English, with these specific values:

Letter	IPA	Sounds like
c	/k/	cake (Oravia has no letter k)
h	/h/, /ɸ/, or /x/	variable, from English h to a soft rasp
j	/dʒ/	jello
r	/r/	the tt in butter, like a flap

Similar-sounding pairs: The vocabulary is designed so that similar pairs never need to be disambiguated: l/r, m/n, p/b, t/d, c/g, f/v, w/v. There is no word that differs from another only by one of these pairs. In practice, you can use similar pronunciations without causing confusion.

Consonant endings: Some syllables end in a consonant. If you find this hard to pronounce, insert a short unstressed i after it (morta or mor(i)ta are both fine).

2.2 Vowels

The vowels are: A E I O U

Letter	IPA	Sounds like
a	/a/	father
e	/ɛ/	cellar
i	/i/	creek
o	/ɔ/	door
u	/u/	flu

Pronouncing E and O closed as in Spanish (/e/ and /o/) is also perfectly fine.

Two vowels together: The preference is to pronounce adjacent vowels as one syllable (as in oRAvia), but two syllables is also acceptable. LiRia (preferred) or liRIa (also fine).

2.3 Stress

Stress always falls on the penultimate syllable (second to last). The exception is when you have a suffix, which is stressed.

coupa → COU-pa
 eledora → e-le-DO-ra
 lidastor → li-DAS-tor
 anparu → an-PA-ru
 anparum (anparu+um) → an-pa-RUM

2.4 Audio Note

Recordings may sound Romance-influenced because of my accent. Try to repeat for mutual intelligibility rather than to copy an exact accent. There is no "right" accent in Oravia.

3. Sentence Structure

3.1 Core Pattern

The fundamental sentence uses four core markers:

a [subject] i [verb] e [direct object] u [indirect object]

Marker	Role	Example
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a	subject — the doer or experiencer	a nim = I
i	verb	i mo = eat
e	direct object	e mocen = chocolate
u	indirect object (to / for)	u falni = to the baby
o	focus / emphasis	o nim! = it's ME!

A basic sentence:

a nim	i mo	e mocen
I	eat	chocolate

Prepositions:

Word	Meaning	Example
de	of / from	de nime faibor = of my spouse
en	time and space	en bo = at home

3.2 Word Order — Marker Blocks Move as Units

A marker and all the words it introduces form a block. The block moves as a unit; you never split the marker away from its phrase.

Each marked phrase is a self-contained block that can move anywhere in the sentence. For example, this is what the block structure looks like:

[SUBJECT my mom and I] [VERB give freely] [DIRECT OBJECT homemade food]
[INDIRECT OBJECT to people in need]

Now an example in Oravia:

[en	yamirli	bo]
↑	↑	↑
loc	old	house

The entire block [en yamirli bo] can move to the beginning, middle, or end of the sentence. But en never splits from its phrase, and yamirli (old) always precedes bo (house).

"I searched in my old house for many years"

nim i copei en yamirli bo en mir lidastor

Four blocks: [nim] · [i copei] · [en yamirli bo] · [en mir lidastor]

All of these ordering examples are valid:

[nim]¹ [i copei]² [en yamirli bo]³ [en mir lidastor]⁴
 [en yamirli bo]³ [nim]¹ [i copei]² [en mir lidastor]⁴
 [en mir lidastor]⁴ [nim]¹ [i copei]² [en yamirli bo]³
 [nim]¹ [en yamirli bo]³ [i copei]² [en mir lidastor]⁴

These are NOT valid because they break a block:

✗ [nim] en [i copei] nime yamirli bo (en split from its block)
 ✗ [nim] [i copei] en nime bo yamirli (yamirli after what it modifies)

Within a block, modifiers always come before what they modify. A long noun phrase like *de yamirli heivio haijor* (of the old magic witch) reads left to right, with each word narrowing the concept of what follows.

3.3 Dropping Markers

Markers can be omitted when meaning is clear from context. The *a* (subject) marker drops most easily, especially with pronouns. The *e* marker drops when the object is unambiguous. The *u* marker is rarely dropped.

Formal:	a hay i mo e mocen	
Casual:	hay i mo e mocen	(a dropped)
Very casual:	hay i mo mocen	(a and e dropped)

4. Pronouns

4.1 Personal Pronouns

Singular		Plural	
nim	I / me	nima	we / us

run	you	runa	you all
hay	he / she / it (singular)	haya	they (plural)

hay is fully gender-neutral. It covers he, she, it, and any singular third person.

4.2 Possessive Pronouns

Add -e to any personal pronoun:

Pronoun → Possessive	Meaning
nim → nime	my / mine
run → rune	your / yours
hay → haye	his / her / its
nima → nima-e	our
haya → haya-e	their

For non-pronoun possession, use de:

de nime faibor	→ my spouse's
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4.3 Zero Pronouns

Oravia omits possessives when ownership is obvious: body parts, family roles, clothing, body actions:

varodu toulum	→ head hurts (not: my head)
farejor i anifi	→ mother is coming (not: my mother)
i siur e yesrel	→ remove the jacket (not: your jacket)

Many sentences don't have a subject. An affirmative sentence without a subject defaults to "I", and a question defaults to "you", like this:

i ilianum = [V] know-not = I don't know
ce i anye? = what [V] do? = what are you doing?

When you connect clauses, if the subject changes from one clause to the next, you must introduce the new subject. This is true even if you would normally not use "I" or "you" if the clauses were their own sentences. This is to prevent ambiguity:

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haya i ilian ca i anye = they know what [they] are doing
haya i ilian ca nim i anye = they know what I am doing
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5. Gender

Oravia has no grammatical gender. hay is fully neutral. Gender can be specified optionally:

Method	Female	Male
Suffix	-jor	-jal
Prefix word	faejor	faejal

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hayjor = she          farejor = mother
faejor fano = daughter faejal fano = son
```

Gender is always optional: use it only when disambiguation is needed.

6. The Copula

The copula (to be) uses the double a pattern. There is no separate verb "to be."

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a [subject]   a   [predicate]
```

Examples:

```
a nim a yalen      → I am tall
a haya a ti        → they are bad
a coupa a ancem hue → the card is turned
a nim a roena hai   → I am a teacher
a bo a no leayo     → the house is like a garden
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If you want to say something like "someone is at a location", you can use just the preposition:

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nim en gedom      → I am in the bank
nim [en] noi       → I am here
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Part II — The Verb System

7. Verbs

7.1 Lexical Flexibility

Any word can be used as a verb by placing *i* before it:

boemo (kitchen)	→	i boemo	= to cook
bonfene (bed)	→	i bonfene	= to lie down
bortal (door)	→	iortal	= to enter
mogali (coffee)	→	i mogali	= to drink coffee

More details about this on §17.

7.2 Aspect Suffixes

Aspect marks the completion state of an action. It is optional: bare verbs are the default.

Suffix	Meaning	Feel
(bare)	general / ongoing / habitual	neutral — the default
-ar	completed action	past-like relative to the main reference
-is	not yet started	future-like relative to the main reference

-ar does not mean "past tense." It means the action is complete relative to the reference moment:

nim i moar cali run i anifi
I had already eaten when you arrived

-is marks something as not yet started:

a anseis	→ a future/upcoming job
litamis	→ tomorrow

The rule is:

- . use the base form of the verb in general.
- . when you want to specify if an action was completed, or if it was done before another action, you can use -ar
- . when you want to specify if an action will yet to start, or if it follows another action, you can use -is

litamar, nim i mouje e mogali
yesterday, I drank coffee → verb in base form, natural

7.3 Negation

Add -um directly to the verb:

nim i moum e moyi → I don't eat sugar
nim i doum i siyal → I cannot find

More information about negation under §13.

7.4 Verb Stacking

Use the short root of the first verb, then the full second verb:

i [root] i [full verb]

Short	Full	Meaning
do	ando	can
dai	anidai	want to
fou	anifou	need to
vil	novil	must (obligation)
tane	daetane	should (recommendation)

nim i do i mo → I can eat
nim i vil i mo → I must eat
nim i tane i mo → I should eat

This is the natural choice in speech. Full forms for the first verb (nim i anidai i bonfene) sound formal or deliberate.

7.5 Must vs. Should

<i>nim i vil i</i> [verb]	→ I must [verb]	– obligation
<i>nim i tane i</i> [verb]	→ I should [verb]	– recommendation

To negate, add -um to the inner verb: *nim i vil i moum* = I have an obligation not to eat.
If you say instead: *nim i vilum i mo*, this means you have no obligation to eat.

8. Habit and Completed Habit

lirul marks habitual or recurring action. *lirular* (-ar on *lirul*) marks a past habit that no longer holds ("used to"):

<i>nim i mo e mogali lirul</i>	→ I habitually drink coffee
<i>nim i mo e mogali lirular</i>	→ I used to drink coffee (but don't anymore)
<i>hay i boemo en bo nealui lirular</i>	→ she used to cook at home half the time

9. Immediate Aspect — noli with -ar and -is

Combining *noli* (now) with the aspect suffixes pins the action to the current moment specifically:

-ar <i>noli</i> = just (completed right now):	
<i>nim i moar noli</i>	→ I just ate
<i>hay i anifar noli</i>	→ she just left
-is <i>noli</i> = about to (starting right now):	
<i>nim i mois noli</i>	→ I'm about to eat
<i>hay i anifis noli</i>	→ she's about to leave

Without *noli*, -ar and -is are relative to the narrative moment. With *noli*, they are anchored to right now. Think of it as the Oravia equivalent of "just did" and "about to."

10. Continuative Aspect

To express that an action started in the past and continues to the present ("have been doing since / for"), Oravia uses the bare verb (ongoing) with two possible time expressions:

10.1 Since a point in time — de + time

Use de (from/of) to mark the starting point. The bare verb signals the action is still ongoing:

```
nim i mo e mogali de litamar
I have been drinking coffee since yesterday

nim i eleme en 'San Antonio de lidastor teva
I have been living in San Antonio for six years

haya i damai de litam cali nim i anifar
they have been arguing since the day I left
```

10.2 For a duration — en + span

Use en (at/in) with a duration to express how long the action has been going on without specifying the start point:

```
nim i mo e mogali en mir lidastor
I have been drinking coffee for many years

hay i copei en par lidastor
she has been searching for three years
```

The bare verb in both constructions signals the action is still active. If the action has since ended, use -ar instead: *nim i moar e mogali en tor lidastor* = I drank coffee for two years (and no longer do).

11. Already, Not Yet, Still, No Longer

These four expressions are extremely common in everyday speech. In Oravia they are built from two words (norven = already, anlaro = continue) with the negation suffix -um.

Expression	Built from	Meaning
noder	noder	already
noderum	noder + -um	not yet (not already)
anlaro	anlaro	still (continues to)
anlaroum	anlaro + -um	no longer (does not continue)

i moar noder	→ I already ate
noder hay i anocari	→ she has already left
ni anlaro-mo	→ I'm still eating
haya anlaro i eleme en bo	→ they still live at home

12. The hai and hue Suffixes

12.1 hai — Agent and Role

hai creates agent nouns: "the one who does X" or "the one whose role is X":

anye hai	→ maker, creator
boemo hai	→ cook
be hai	→ traveler
heivio hai	→ witch / wizard

To remember it: hai contains a (actor) + i (verb), the actor-verb combination.

12.2 hue — Recipient and Resultant State

hue marks the thing in a state of having been acted upon:

anye hue	→ the made thing, a creation
a coupa a ancem hue	→ the card is (in the state of being) turned

To remember it: hue contains u (indirect) + e (object), the receiver side.

12.3 hue vs. -ar

-ar narrates that an event happened. hue describes the resulting state:

a coupa i ancemar	→ the card turned (the event)
a coupa a ancem hue	→ the card is turned (current state)

13. Negation

13.1 -um — no/not

nim i moum e moyi	→ I don't eat sugar (mo + um)
nim i doum i siyal	→ I cannot find (do + um)
moyium moulu	→ milk with no sugar (moyi + um)

13.2 ho — Opposite

ho before any word creates its opposite:

a nim a ho yalen	→ I am short (not-tall)
nim i ho bonfene	→ I stand up (opposite of lie down)

Compare: -um negates; ho inverts a quality:

nim i moum e mocen	→ I don't eat chocolate (negation)
a mocen a ho yuba	→ chocolate is unpleasant (opposite quality)

The negation suffix tends to go last, like this:

i moar	→ I ate
i moarum	→ I didn't eat

In many cases, we may prefer to drop a suffix or rephrase rather than stack suffixes.

14. Negation Scope

Oravia has more specific scope negators for particular contexts. These are just examples not to be memorized, you can use any word in this function depending on what you want to say.

Word	Meaning	Use
elirevaum	not true	factual correction of a whole proposition
oiyarum	not the emphasis	corrects what is being highlighted: "it's not THAT, it's THIS"
datelium	not the situation	the circumstances are different, it's not the case

For most purposes, elirevaum is the right choice. Use the others when you want to be precise about what aspect of a claim you are pushing back on.

Part III — Questions and Description

15. Questions

15.1 Yes/No Questions

Raise intonation on the same sentence. No structural change needed:

run i mo?	→ Are you eating?
a hay en bo?	→ Is she at home?

If you want, you can add in the end of the sentence: "dou ce?" (or what?) or "ia? / dasu?" (yes? / right?).

To answer, you can say "ia" (yes), "um" (no), or use a sentence fragment (e.g., "mo", "boum").

15.2 Question Words

All question words are built from ce (what) plus a domain word. The pattern is open-ended, and new question words can be formed by combining ce with any relevant domain word.

Word	Built from	Meaning
ce	—	what?
cei	ce + ei (person)	who?
cedom	ce + dom (place)	where?
celi	ce + li (time)	when?
ceora	ce + ora (idea)	why?
cemir	ce + mir (many)	how many?
cenon	ce + non (way/manner)	how? (in what way?)
cene	ce + ne (gradation)	how [adjective]? (how tall? how intense?)

ce run i mo?	→ What are you eating?
cei i mouje e moulu?	→ Who is drinking milk?
cedom run i anvu?	→ Where are you going?
cemir falen i dami?	→ How many children are there?

cenon run i boemo?	→ How do you cook?
cene yalen a run?	→ How tall are you?

15.3 Connector Equivalents

In non-question sentences, question words become connectors (instead of *ce*, use *ca*):

Question	Connector	Meaning in statements
ce	ca	that / which
cei	caei	who
cedom	cadom	where
celi	cali	when
ceora	caora	because / the reason
cenon	canon	the way in which / how
cene	cane	to the degree that / as [adjective] as

nim i siyal ca a eledora a eodyel	→ I noticed that fate was joining us
caora nim i anifar, i doum i anivari	→ because I left, I couldn't return

15.4 The Multiple Meanings of "How"

"How" in English covers several distinct concepts, each handled differently in Oravia:

cenon / canon — manner (in what way)

Asks or states the method or manner of doing something:

cenon run i boemo?	→ How do you cook? (what method?)
hay i anye canon nim i ilaluan u hay	→ she does it the way I told her

cene / cane — degree (how much, how tall, how intense)

Built from *ne* (the gradation system), it asks about intensity or degree on the 0–10 scale:

cene yalen a run?	→ How tall are you?
cene tohpu a run?	→ How sad are you?

nim i anvu cane run the same degree)	→ I go as much as you (to the same degree)
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How much as in price follows the same logic: ce + gaolei (what + price, value), and you can create new question words by making other combinations.

16. Marker Disambiguation in Questions and Relative Clauses

Oravia's role markers can be placed directly before a question word or relative connector to specify what grammatical role the questioned or relativized element plays within its clause. It's optional when context is clear, but invaluable when a sentence would otherwise be ambiguous.

16.1 In Questions

Without a marker, ce (what/who) is ambiguous about its role. Placing a marker before ce makes it explicit:

e ce i mo?	→ what is being eaten? (ce = direct object)
a ce i mo?	→ who eats? (ce = subject)
u ce nim i ilaluan?	→ to whom am I speaking? (ce = indirect object)

The marker immediately before ce signals the role of the unknown. Dedicated question words like cedom and cei are shortcuts for the most common cases (en ce for where, a ce + person for who), but the marker-plus-ce construction is available for any role.

16.2 In Relative Clauses

The same principle applies to relative connectors. A marker before ca or caei specifies the role of the modified noun inside the embedded clause:

i none e miau a ca i mo	
I have the cat [SUBJ who] eats	
(the cat is the subject of eating)	
i none e miau e ca i mo	
I have the cat [OBJ that] I eat	
(the cat is the object: I eat it)	
i none e miau u ca i ilaluan	
I have the cat [IO that] I speak to	

(the cat is the indirect object)

Without the marker, the connector alone (ca, caei) leaves the role implicit and relies on context. With the marker, there is no ambiguity regardless of word order in the embedded clause.

The same principle applies to any connector:

i vardei e ilhei	a caei	i ilaluan u run
I see the person	[SUBJ who]	spoke to you
i vardei e ilhei	e caei	run i ilaluan
I see the person	[OBJ who]	you spoke to

The marker before the connector travels with it as a unit, just like any other marker block.

17. Indirect Questions

17.1 Whether / yes-no

Ca introduces an embedded content clause: a fact, a claim, or a proposition. If we don't know whether something is true, we use "ia dou" (yes or...), which means "whether".

Examples

Verb	Meaning	Example
ilianum	not know	i ilianum ia dou hay i anocari → I don't know whether she left
daelan	judge / evaluate	i daelan ia dou a selyino a norfih ciugai → I'm evaluating whether the plan is sufficiently detailed
iliro	think / consider	i iliro ia dou a bociu a yuba → I wonder if the decoration is good
vardei	see / check	i vardei ia dou a bontame a noi → I'm checking whether the table is here
siyal	find out	i siyal ia dou i do i roena → I'm finding out whether I can teach

17.2 Thing vs. Fact

Sometimes, a sentence like this can be ambiguous:

i ilianum ca hay i dairan. (V know-not connector he V like)

Does this mean I do not know what it is that he likes, or I do not know the fact that he likes it?

To resolve this ambiguity, we can make the meaning explicit:

Addition	Meaning	Example
ilwol	thing	i ilianum ilwol ca hay i dairan → I don't know the thing he likes
elireva	truth, fact	i ilianum elireva ca hay i dairan → I don't know the fact that he likes it

Notice that for other types of question words (cadom, caei, cali, etc) this ambiguity does not appear. For this reason, you can use them as indirect questions without concern.

i ilianum cadom run (V know-not where you) = I don't know where you are

18. Connectors and Conjunctions

18.1 Basic Connectors

Word	Meaning	Example
su	and / also / with	i mo e mocen su e moaria
dou	or	i mo e mocen dou e moaria
mai	but	i anidai mo, mai i doum
eta	therefore / so	i daium, eta i anifou i mo

su is versatile: it connects nouns, verbs, and full sentences:

i mo e mocen su e moaria	→ I eat chocolate and apple
i mo su i mouje	→ I eat and drink
i anvu su run	→ I go with you

18.2 Temporal Connectors

Word	Meaning
notam	first / before (the earlier event)

notor	then / second (the later event)
cali	when
lar	once / at some point in the past
noli	now
noi	here / this
yadetu	finally
tonan	suddenly

notam and notor mark order, not calendar time:

notam i mo, notor i bonfene	→ first I eat, then I lie down
notam i mo, i bonfene	→ (first) I eat, (then) I lie down

19. Numbers

19.1 Cardinal Numbers 1–10

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
tam	tor	par	balem	alui	teva	peri	auta	tenda	das

19.2 Numbers Beyond 10

Larger unit first:

das tam = 11	das par = 13	tor das = 20
par das = 30	par das balem = 34	

19.3 Ordinals

Add -ganter to any cardinal: tam ganter = first, tor ganter = second, par ganter = third

19.4 Time Units

Word	Meaning	Built from
litam	day	li + tam (1)
liperi	week	li + peri (7)

lipardas	month	li + pardas (30)
lidastor	year	li + dastor (12)

litamar = yesterday	litamis = tomorrow
liperiar = last week	liperaris = next week

19.5 Large Numbers — nen / ponen

ponen (power), short form nen, base 10:

nen tor = 100 (10^2)
nen par = 1,000 (10^3)
nen teva = 1,000,000 (10^6)
nen tenda = 1,000,000,000 (10^9)

For example, one may say:

auta nen tor = 800

tor nen teva = 2,000,000

mir nen tenda = billions

19.6 Atomic Numbers — pogai

Chemical elements by pogai (atom) + atomic number:

pogai auta = oxygen (8)	pogai tor das teva = iron (26)
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20. Fractional Numbers

Fractions use the pattern [numerator] de [denominator], literally "X of Y." de is the same "of/from" already in the grammar.

tam de tor	= 1 of 2 = half
tam de par	= 1 of 3 = a third
tam de alem	= 1 of 4 = a quarter
tam de das	= 1 of 10 = a tenth
tor de par	= 2 of 3 = two thirds

In use:

i mo e tam de tor	→ I ate half the food
hay i none e tam de balem de nen tor	→ she has a quarter of 100

a tam de tor de lidastor i dami → half a year remains (ligo can also be used, meaning "half")

For common fractions in everyday speech, the ne gradation system often serves just as well: nealui = 5/10 = half, neteva = 6/10 etc. Use the de construction when the exact fraction matters.

21. Existential Sentences — dami

dami (to exist / there is) forms existential statements:

i dami a moaria → there is an apple
cedom a bonfene i dami? → where is the bed?
en bo i dami a yunitam mo → in the house there is a special dish

22. Adjectives and Modifier Order

The modifier always comes first:

mogali moulu → coffee milk = coffee-flavored milk
yamirli heivio hai → old magic-doer (witch/wizard)

22.1 Compounds — the -a Suffix

Adding -a to a modifying word signals they are forming one concept, rather than working as an adjective:

Phrase	Reading
yaltan miau	a big cat (any big cat, descriptive)
yaltana miau	big-cat as a type = lion or tiger
yedia yaltana miau	striped-big-cat = tiger specifically
yahlul yaltan apafene	a seat that is soft and big
yahlula yaltana apafene	soft-big-seat = couch (concept)

If there is ambiguity, rephrase or add more descriptors.

Here are a few more examples:

lufua bei = air-vehicle = airplane
waa jasru = ocean-bend = bay
lufua yahlul = air-soft = fluffy
waa garel = water-up = fountain
yalgaia mus = small-bug = ant
selyinoa li = plan-time = schedule
waa dom = water-land = island

Notice you can be as specific as you'd like by adding more descriptions to your compound. If you think *lufua bei* (air-vehicle) is not enough specificity for what you want to express as airplane, you can for example say *jeluina lufua bei* (winged-air-vehicle).

22.2 Hyphenated Combinations

Combine words freely. The hyphen signals is different from the compound because its main function is not to describe a single concept using multiple words. Instead, it is giving flavor and color to the second word.

i ilofun-vardei → *to hesitant-look, to peek with doubt*
i toului-asfe → *to tired-stop, to give up*
i raidana-ilaluan → *to surrender-say, to concede*
i tosrei-neiden → *to bitter-develop, to feed into your bitterness*

You can also use hyphens to achieve more fine-grained meanings, blending two experiential flavors together. This is commonly done with emotions or abstract nouns:

aela-tohlel → *joy + longing, a type of nostalgic happiness*
tohpu-oipoh → *sadness + excitement, a type of bittersweetness, holding loss and anticipation at once*
mirli-elivon → *much time + wisdom, understanding that comes with time*

22.3 Imported Words and Scientific Names

Words not in the official vocabulary are preceded by ' (apostrophe). There are three common cases:

a) Names, places, dishes, languages, religions, ethnicities and other cultural words: use the name the community uses, such as 'Italia for Italy and 'Nihongo for Japanese language

b) Flora and fauna: use the scientific names with a definition at first use. For example, "robin" is *turdus*, "palm tree" is *palmae*, "daffodil" is *narcissus*, and "tarragon" is *artemisia dracunculus*.

Using scientific names has many advantages: it makes the referent more specific (different languages have difference conceptual spaces for flora and fauna), it avoids adding thousands of created words to the vocabulary, and we learn new things

c) Coined or created words: new words invented by a speaker for style or a concept not in the official list

For species and coined words, define the word at its first use with a compound:

```
En borlu, i vardei e 'miautan.  
*miautan = yedia yaltana miao, *panthera tigris*
```

The ' signals to the reader: this word is not in the core vocabulary. Imported and coined words never enter the core vocabulary.

23. Adverbs and the Adjective/Adverb Distinction

In Oravia, any word can function as a modifier. Context usually makes the adjective/adverb reading clear. When disambiguation is needed, three strategies are available:

23.1 Hyphenated Verb

Hyphenate the modifier to the verb to signal it modifies the action, not a noun:

```
nim i yasoi-apavu      → I fast-run / I run fast  
(yasoi bound to apavu: the running is fast)
```

23.2 Fronted Modifier Outside the Verb Block

Place the modifier outside the verb block to signal it applies to the action as a whole:

```
yasoi nim i apavu      → fast, I run = I run fast  
(yasoi outside [nim] and [i apavu] blocks)
```

23.3 Adjective Use

A modifier before a noun reads as an adjective:

a yasoi apavu	→ a fast runner
a yaltan bo	→ a big house
a yamirli heivio hai	→ an old witch

23.4 Explicit Markers

For absolute clarity, use the explicit role markers:

non (way/manner) marks an adverbial phrase:

i apavu non yasoi	→ I run in a fast way
-------------------	-----------------------

ya (objective quality) marks an adjectival reading explicitly:

a ya anro ilhei	→ a person who has the quality of
decision, decisive	

These explicit markers are optional in most contexts but resolve ambiguity in complex sentences.

24. Comparison

24.1 Comparative — ga

ga means "compared to." It introduces the reference point:

ga [x], a [y] a [adjective]	
compared to x, y is more [adjective]	
ga nime fasujal, a nim a yamirli	→ I am older than my
brother	
a bo a yaltan ga rune	→ my house is bigger than yours

24.2 Equality — gaomem

gaomem means "the same." With ga it expresses "as [adjective] as":

ga run, a nim a gaomem yalen	→ I am as tall as you
a haye dairan a gaomem de nime	→ her preference is the same as mine

24.3 Superlative — anodu

anodu means "top / the most." Use de to specify the group:

a [y] a anodu [adjective] de [group]	
a rune fano a anodu yalen	→ your child is the tallest
a fattore a anodu yunro de fattore	→ my teacher is the smartest among teachers

25. The ne Gradation System

ne + number expresses degree on a scale from 0 to 10. It applies to any gradable word:

Expression	Meaning
nesunya [word]	0/10 — not at all
netor [word]	2/10 — a little
nepar [word]	3/10 — somewhat
nealem [word]	4/10 — fairly
nealui [word]	5/10 — halfway
neteva [word]	6/10 — rather
neperi [word]	7/10 — quite
neauta [word]	8/10 — very
nedas [word]	10/10 — completely
nedastam [word]	11/10 — too much

With lirul (habit) — frequency:

nesunya lirul = never	nepar lirul = sometimes
neauta lirul = often	nedas lirul = every time

With ilie (likelihood):

nesunya ilie = impossible	nealui ilie = 50/50
neperi ilie = likely	nedas ilie = certainly

With a context word — precise descriptions:

nebalem antori = 4/10 open = ajar
nepar luyar = 3/10 light = dimly lit

Notice this allows for expressiveness, precision and avoids adding dozens of words to the vocabulary.

26. Pluralization and Definiteness

26.1 Pluralization

Oravia has no plural morphology. The bare noun covers both singular and plural; context usually makes the number clear:

miau i bonfene	→ a cat is sleeping / cats are sleeping
----------------	---

When explicit plurality is needed, use mir (many) or a number directly before the noun:

mir miau	→ many cats
tor miau	→ two cats
par das miau	→ thirty cats

26.2 Definiteness

There are no articles. Definiteness is handled pragmatically: first mention is typically indefinite, subsequent mention is definite. When additional specificity is needed, demonstratives or context words anchor the reference:

o miau	→ the cat (o = emphasis)
noi miau	→ this cat (noi = here/this)
tam ganter litam	→ the first day (in a sequence)

27. Only and Also/Too

27.1 netam — Only

netam (from ne + tam = single/one) means "only." It precedes what it restricts, just like other modifiers:

i anidai netam e mogali	→ I want only coffee
netam o nim i none	→ only I have it
a netam litam i dami	→ there is only one day left
hay i anicavori netam caora tohpu sadness	→ she left only because of sadness

27.2 su — Also/Too

su already appears as the connector "and/also/with" (placed before or between elements). When placed after a word, it takes on the meaning "also / too," emphasizing that the word it follows is included in addition to something already established.

The position distinguishes the two uses:

Before/between = "and/with" (connector):	
nim su run i anvu	→ I and you go / I go with you
After a word = "also/too" (focus):	
hay i anifar su	→ she also left / she left too
nim i mo, hay su	→ I eat; she does too
neloa i mo su	→ everyone also eats

The "also/too" use of su is the same word; context and position make the reading clear.

28. The Emphasis Marker o

o is the fifth sentence marker. It spotlights whatever immediately follows it.

General emphasis

o nim!	→ it's ME!
nima o i anvu	→ we ARE going
o jerih	→ THE tower
run o faibor	→ you're the one (romantic context)

o is very versatile. Take a look at this exchange:

bi yuba	(that's good)
---------	---------------

| o yuba! (it sure is!)

Before a verb — imperative

When o precedes a verb without a specified subject, it reads as a command:

o i anona!	→ Give it!
o yadetu!	→ Stop!
o i anvu!	→ Go!

Before the object — passive

When o precedes an e-marked object, the object becomes the focus. This is the passive-like construction:

o e micea i copei	→ the rabbit was hunted
i mouje o e moulu	→ the milk was drunk

Summary:

o [word]	→ emphasis / spotlight
o i [verb]	→ imperative
o e [object]	→ passive

Own — Possession with Emphasis

Oravia has no separate word for "own." To express "my own", place o before the possessive phrase:

nime bo	→ my house
o nime bo	→ my OWN house / specifically my house
de elihei	→ of self (if additional clarity is needed)

The o marker already in the language carries the meaning; no new vocabulary needed.

Part IV — Building Complex Sentences

29. Passive Voice

29.1 o e — Emphasis on object (event passive)

The most common passive uses the o marker before the e-marked object. The subject recedes and the object becomes the focus:

o e leirih i vonlu	→ the tree was touched
i yean o e yemiodu	→ the pillow was sewn
a eofo i vanpai o e falen friend	→ the kid was kicked by the

29.2 hue — Resultant state passive

hue after a verb describes the resulting state, not the event itself, but how things stand now:

a coupa a ancem hue state)	→ the card is turned (current
-------------------------------	-------------------------------

29.3 Choosing between them

o e coupa i anopu narration)	→ the card was lost (event
a coupa a anopu hue state)	→ the card is lost (current

30. The Speaker Comment Marker bi

bi introduces the speaker's emotional reaction or editorial commentary: not neutral content, but how the speaker feels about what is being said. bi phrases can be inserted anywhere and can stand alone:

nim i faigel bi oipoh!	→ I'm getting married – how exciting!
bi oila a nim en bo	→ I'm so happy to be home

Alone, bi phrases work as pure exclamation:

bi oipoh!	→ how exciting!
bi tohpu!	→ how sad!
bi oila!	→ wonderful! / I'm so glad!

They can also be combined:

`bi ti-yuba` → that's bittersweet (bad-good)

31. Sentence-Final and Clause-Final Particles

Many languages use small particles at the end of sentences to add emotional tone, epistemic stance, or pragmatic coloring. Oravia handles most of this through a small set of elements that can appear in sentence-final or clause-final position.

31.1 bi — Emotional / Editorial Comment

bi is the primary one. It can appear anywhere but naturally gravitates toward sentence-final or pre-comment positions. We covered this under §31

31.2 ilie — Epistemic Hedging

ilie (maybe/likelihood) at the end of a sentence softens it into a possibility or expresses the speaker's uncertainty:

`nim i anvu ilie` → I might go / I'm going maybe
`hay i anifi litamis ilie` → she might arrive tomorrow

31.3 o — Spotlight / Assertion

o at the end of a phrase or sentence puts final emphasis on what just came, asserting it or marking it as the key point:

`o hay !` → it's HER!
`o noi` → right here (emphasis on the location)
`hay o i anocariar` → she DID leave

31.4 The System as a Whole

These three (bi, ilie, and o) cover the main functions of sentence-final particles cross-linguistically:

Element	Function	Analogy
bi	emotional/editorial commentary	Japanese ね、よ、わ... and more

ilie	epistemic uncertainty / softening	English "maybe", Japanese かも
o	spotlight / assertion / emphasis	Japanese ぞ、よ (assertive)

The system is deliberately minimal; these three elements combine to cover a wide range of pragmatic coloring.

32. Relative Clauses

Oravia forms relative clauses using the same connectors introduced in §10: *ca*, *caei*, *cadom*, *cali*, *caora*, *canon*, *cane*. The connector comes immediately after the noun being modified and introduces the subordinate clause. The connector slot simply matches the grammatical role of the missing element within the relative clause.

The key connectors and their roles in relative clauses:

Connector	Use in relative clause
<i>ca</i>	replaces a thing (object, fact): the food that, the idea that
<i>caei</i>	replaces a person: the person who
<i>cadom</i>	replaces a place: the house where
<i>cali</i>	replaces a time: the day when
<i>caora</i>	replaces a reason: the reason why
<i>canon</i>	replaces a manner: the way in which

Examples:

```
a ilhei caei i ilaluan u nim
the person who told me
(ilhei = person; caei replaces the subject of ilaluan)

a bo cadom nim i elemei
the house where I live
(cadom replaces the location)

a mo ca nim i anidai
the food that I want
(ca replaces the object of anidai)

a litam cali nim i anifar
```

the day when I left
(cali replaces the time)

Whose and With Which

For whose we can rephrase the sentence, or use "cade" (ca + de, possessive):

faejal cade fano nim i ilian
(the man whose child I know)

"With which / using which" — the knife with which I cut bread:

a jahvel ca nim i anja i jasrec e malvae
(the knife that I use to cut bread)

jasrec malvae jahvel
(cut bread knife)

33. Reported and Direct Speech

33.1 Reported Speech

Reported (indirect) speech uses ca as the connector between the speech verb and the reported clause. The reported clause takes its own markers as if it were a standalone sentence, with no change of person or tense required, since Oravia has no obligatory marking:

i ilaluan ca hay i anvu
I said that he is going

haya i ilaluan ca a nim a ti
they said that I am bad

nfarejor i ilaluan ca litamis i dami a yuba mo
my mother said that tomorrow there will be good food

33.2 Direct Speech

Direct (verbatim) speech uses no as connector, or quotations. The quoted speech follows the speech verb immediately:

i ilaluan no hay i anvu
I said such: he is going

farejor i ilaluan "litamis i dami a yuba mo"
my mother said "tomorrow there will be good food"

34. Coordination Within Phrases

su (and/also/with) works at both the sentence level and inside phrases. Its position determines what it coordinates.

34.1 Coordinating Adjectives (One Noun)

su between two adjectives before a noun = both adjectives modify the same noun:

yohisa su yoyol beivu → red-and-blue vehicle
(one vehicle that is both red and blue)

yuba su yunro hai → good-and-smart person
(one person who is both)

34.2 Coordinating Noun Phrases (Multiple Nouns)

su between two full noun phrases = two separate referents:

yohisa beivu su yoyol beivu → red vehicle and blue vehicle
(two separate vehicles)

yuba hai su yunro hai → a good person and a smart person
(two people)

34.3 Coordinating Verbs and Objects

The same logic applies to verbs and objects:

nim i mo su i mouje → I eat and drink (two verbs)

nim i mo e mocen su e moaria → I eat chocolate and apple (two objects)

nim i mo e mocen su nim i mouje e mogali
→ I eat chocolate, and I drink coffee (two full clauses)

35. Correlatives

Correlatives are expressions like "everyone," "somewhere," "nothing," "always." They are built with words already in the vocabulary.

35.1 Quantity Words

sunya	→ no / none / not any
nehen	→ each
noniu	→ some / a certain
neloa	→ all / every

35.2 Combining with Domain Words

Add a domain word to specify the type of referent. The most common combinations:

+ ilhei (person/self)	
sunya ilhei	→ no one
nehen ilhei	→ each person
noniu ilhei	→ someone
neloa ilhei	→ everyone
+ dom (place)	
sunya dom	→ nowhere
nehen dom	→ each place
noniu dom	→ somewhere
neloa dom	→ everywhere
+ ora (idea / reason)	
sunya ora	→ for no reason
nehen ora	→ each reason
noniu ora	→ for some reason
neloa ora	→ for any reason / every reason
+ mo (food / thing in context)	
sunya mo	→ nothing to eat / nothing [in food context]
nehen mo	→ each food
noniu mo	→ something to eat
neloa mo	→ everything, all the food

Any domain word works; the pattern is fully open. noniu litam = some day, sunya elemi dom = nowhere to live, nelo a de nim = everything of mine.

35.3 Dropping the Domain Word

When the referent type is clear from context, the domain word drops. The quantity word alone carries the full meaning:

neloa i ilian	→ everyone knows
(ilhei dropped – the subject slot already implies a person-doer)	
noniu i dami en bo	→ something is in the house
neloa a ancem hue	→ everything has been turned

That's the norm in speech. The full form (neloa ilhei, neheh ilhei) is used when the domain genuinely needs to be made explicit or for emphasis.

36. Conditionals

36.1 iliciu — Counterfactual / Imagined

Use iliciu for hypothetical, contrary-to-fact, or imagined situations.

iliciu i ilian canon, i anye	→ if I knew how, I would do it
iliciu i moarum, toumo	→ if I hadn't eaten, I would have been hungry

36.2 daehun — Factual If-Then

Use daehun for logical truths and real-world cause-and-effect:

daehun nim i apanou e moaria, a moaria i apanou
if I drop the apple, it falls

Notice that by using iliciu and daehun, we avoid many complicated verb forms in a lot of languages including English.

37. Concession — noder + mai

Noder means "even." Paired with mai (but), it expresses concession, as in "even though X, Y." The structure is: noder [conceded clause], mai [main clause].

i none e beivu, mai i dai i vanvu.

I have a car, but I like to walk.

Noder i none e beivu, mai i dai i vanvu.

Even (though) I have a car, I like to walk.

i eodya hue, mai anvum.

I was invited, but I am not going.

Noder i eodya hue, mai anvum.

Even (though) I was invited, I am not going.

noder alone works as "even" in other contexts:

noder nim i ando → even I can

noder nepar → even a little

38. The More... The More...

The correlative neron (more / additional) can be doubled across two clauses to express the proportional relationship "the more X, the more Y":

neron hay i 'asufu, neron be hai i vanta e jovabo en hay

the more it blew, the more the traveler held his cloak around him

The pattern: neron [first clause], neron [second clause]. The two neron phrases work just like the English "the more... the more..." — each intensification of the first event drives an intensification of the second.

neron nim i ilaluan, neron nim i ando

the more I speak, the more I can

neron haya i mo, neron haya a yunro

the more they eat, the smarter they are

For the reverse ("the more X, the less Y"), combine neron with gafi or a negated form:

neron nim i bonfene, gafi nim i apavu

the more I sleep, the less I run

Part V — Semantic Nuance

39. Relational Words

Oravia has words that work like prepositions, specifying the semantic relationship between a phrase and the rest of the sentence. Unlike English prepositions, these are full content words with their own meanings. They always introduce a block and travel with it.

39.1 (da)sora — Purpose

sora (short form of dasora) marks the purpose or goal of an action. In English: "in order to," "to," "for the purpose of":

i anvu sora i gerina	→ I go to buy / in order to buy
e coupa i anja sora daelipo	→ the cards are used for
prophecy	

39.2 jetai — Direction

jetai marks direction toward something. In English: "toward," "in the direction of":

i anvu jetai bo	→ I go toward the house
nim jetai bo	→ I go toward the house
hay i anvu e varsus jetai nim	→ she directed her ear toward me

jetai is directional, not locational. Compare:

nim i dami en bo	→ I am at home (static location)
nim i anvu jetai bo	→ I go toward the house (direction of movement)

39.3 anja — Instrument

anja marks the tool or means used to accomplish something. In English: "using," "by means of," "with" (instrumental):

i ilaluan anja coupa	→ I communicate by card
i mo anja jadun	→ I eat with a fork
i anvu anja bei	→ I travel by vehicle

anja is also a standalone verb meaning "to use" (nim i anja e coupa = I use the card). Notice that the most common way to talk about using things is to construct them as verbs:

i jadun	→ I eat with a fork
i beivu	→ I go by car

39.4 caora — Reason (relational use)

caora appears as a connector (because / the reason) but also introduces a reason phrase:

a nim a tohpu caora siur de haye	→ I am sad because of her disappearance
i moum caora tovei	→ I don't eat because of illness

As connector (introduces a clause):

caora a nim a toumo, i mo	→ because I'm hungry, I eat
---------------------------	-----------------------------

39.5 (an)lor — Benefit

lor (short form of anlor) deepens the meaning of u by marking that an action is done specifically for someone's benefit, not just directed at them as a recipient, but genuinely serving their interest.

Compare u and u lor:

i anye u run	→ I do it for you (you are the recipient)
i anye u lor run	→ I do it for your benefit (a gift / act of service for you)

u marks who receives. u lor adds that the action is a meaningful gift or service done out of care or generosity: the difference between handing someone something and genuinely doing something for them.

i boemo u lor run	→ I cook for your benefit (as a kindness)
hay i ilaluan u lor haya	→ she told them for their sake (to help them)

i copei e coupa u lor nima our sake	→ I searched for the card for
--	-------------------------------

This maps some natural languages, for example Japanese ageru and Portuguese por as distinct from para. u lor has the flavor of a deeper gift or act of service.

40. Location and Spatial Words

40.1 en — Location and Time

en marks location (at, in, on) and time:

i eleme en 'San Antonio	→ I live in San Antonio
hay en bo	→ she is at home
i copei en mir lidastor	→ I searched for many years
en liyar	→ in the morning

40.2 Spatial Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
en	at / in / on (location)
jenpur	under / below
ganrih	above / over / up
jenparo	front / forward
anolu	out / away / external
jetai	direction / toward
noi	here
nordau	far
widuo	near / close by

41. no — Similitive and Nominal Complement

no means "like / as / similar to." One of the most versatile words in the language, it has two related uses.

41.1 Similitive — comparing actions or manners

Use *no* to describe how something is done, or what something resembles in behavior:

hay i vanvu no yamirli	→ she walks like an old person
hay i neiden no falen	→ she runs like a child
hay i bonfene no toulu	→ she sleeps like she is tired

no always comes before what it modifies.

41.2 Nominal Complement — secondary predicate after a verb

no also serves as a nominal complement — it introduces what something is called, considered, or perceived as.

Some verbs this appears with: *ilaluan* (say), *daelan* (judge/consider), *nomie* (appear/seem), *iliro* (think as), *couya* (to call as).

i couya e run no hehma	→ I call you a monster
i daelan e hay no ti	→ I judge him as bad / I consider him bad
i nomie no yufer	→ it looks dirty / it appears dirty
i iliro ciude run no elonemi hai	→ I think about you as a savior

The pattern generally is [verb] *e* [object] *no* [characterization], where the *no* phrase tells you what the object is being called, judged, or perceived as. Compare with the copula for direct identity:

a run a hehma	→ you ARE a monster (direct statement)
i couya e run no hehma	→ I CALL you a monster (framing via verb)

42. Sensory and Perceptual Constructions

nomie means "to move/seem/appear" in a general sense. Combined with *no* (like/as), it covers the English "it seems," "it appears," "it looks like," etc.:

i nomie no lupupi	→ it seems like rain / it looks like rain
i nomie no elemi hue	→ it seems inhabited / it appears to be lived in

To specify which sense is involved, combine *nomie* with the relevant sensory word, either hyphenated or as a separate block:

vardei (eye / sight):

i nomie-vardei no lupupi → it looks like rain
i nomie no lupupi daci → it looks like rain (shape)

varsus (ear / hearing):

i nomie-varsus no lupupi → it sounds like rain
i nomie no lupupi om → it sounds like rain (sound)

varpi (nose / smell):

i nomie-varpi no lupupi → it smells like rain
i nomie no lupui varpi → it smells like rain

varluan (tongue / taste):

i nomie-varluan no moval mogali → it tastes like iced coffee

The sensory word specifies the modality; *no* introduces the comparison. Without a sensory word, *nomie no* is the general "seems/appears like" applicable to any perception or impression.

43. Causatives

Causative constructions use verb stacking with *ponen* (power, to impose). The one being made to do something takes the *e* (object) marker as the direct object of *pohnen*. The caused action follows with *i*:

i ponen ca e [causee] i [caused action]

i ponen ca e hay i mo
I made that him eat
(I imposed on him: eat)

farejor i ponen ca e nim i bonfene
my mother made me lie down

haya i ponen ca e falen i ilaluan
they made the child speak

"Ca" may be omitted if it's clear.

The strength of imposition scales with context. *ponen* implies genuine forcing or imposition.

For a softer causative, we use "antai", to guide:

```
i antai ca e [causee] i [caused action]
```

```
i antai ca e hay i mo
```

```
I guided that him eat
```

```
farejor i antai ca e nim i bonfene
```

```
my mother guided me to lie down
```

```
haya i antai ca e falen i ilaluan
```

```
they guided the child to speak
```

When we are talking about emotions, states, or general things that do not require that the affected person perform an action, we use a different construction. In this case, an omitted subject means a vague cause, and you use the *e* marker for the person affected:

```
i [state] e [person affected]
```

```
i tohpu e nim
```

```
this makes me sad
```

```
elenom i toulum e falen
```

```
the journey tires the child
```

```
a haye ilaluan i oipoh e nim
```

```
her words excite me
```

44. Reflexives and Reciprocals

Word	Meaning
elihei	self
rein	each other

haya i vardei e elihei	→ they look at themselves
haya i vardei e rein	→ they look at each other
i ilaluan u elihei	→ I talk to myself

45. Instead — domvio

domvio (dom = place + davio = change) means "instead," as in: in the place of, as a substitute for. It works as a relational word introducing the thing being replaced:

i mouje domvio i mo	→ I drank instead of eating
domvio i mo, i mouje	→ instead of eating, I drank
hay i anvu domvio nim	→ she went instead of me
hay i anvu domvio lor nim	→ she went instead of me (as a sacrifice or gift)

domvio can also be used as a verb meaning "to substitute / to take the place of":

i domvio e hay en anse	→ I substituted for her in my job
a mogali i domvio e moulu	→ coffee replaced milk

46. Become, Turn Into, Start To

Oravia expresses "become," "turn into," and "start to" through two words: ansau (start) and ancem (turn / change state).

(an)sau — start

Ansau means "to start." Stack it with another verb to express "begin doing / start to". Just as with other verb stacking, you can use short form:

i ansau i toului	→ I start to be tired / I get tired
i sau i ilian	→ I start to understand / I come to understand
hay i sau i anvu	→ she starts going / she starts to leave

(da)vio — change into / become

Davio means "change", you use "no" as complement:

i davio no roena hai → I become a teacher
(I become a teacher)

a jevial i davio no lenodur → the statue turns into stone

hay i davio no yamirli → she becomes old

As with other hyphenated expressions, you can express change like this instead:

a jevial i lenodur-davio → the statue turns into stone

hay i yamirli-davio → she becomes old

For "get [adjective]" (get tired, get warm), both can apply depending on whether you emphasize the start of the process or arrival at the new state:

i ansau i toului → I start getting tired (process beginning)

i davio no toului → I become tired (arrival at state)

Remember as well that you can use any word as a verb:

i yohisa e borcai → to turn/to make the wall red (lit. to red the wall)

47. Wish and Jussive

47.1 bi iloi — Wish

bi iloi (bi = speaker comment + iloi = hope) expresses a wish or hope about something:

bi iloi hay i anefene → I wish/hope she rests

bi iloi a litamis a yuba → I hope tomorrow is good

bi iloi nim i do i anocari → I wish I could leave

bi iloi run i anocari → I hope you leave

47.2 o i — Jussive (Let's)

The same o i [verb] construction used for commands (§5) also covers the first-person plural invitation ("let's"). Context makes the reading clear: this can be like an order or invitation.

nima o i mo! → Let's (we) eat!

You can use "what do you think", which is not as ambiguous:

ce iliro nima i mo? → what do you think we eat?

48. Words in Flexible Roles

48.1 Words as Verbs

Any word becomes a verb when placed after i. For many word types, the meaning follows the default *to use it in its primary function*:

Word type	Default verb meaning	Example
Object / tool	as to use it	i jadur = to use a fork
Food / drink	to consume it	i mogali = to drink coffee
Container / surface	to put in/on it depending on object function	i bontame = to put on the table
Clothing / accessory	to put it on	i yesrel = to put on a jacket
Body part	to use it in its primary function	i varsus = to listen
Time Period	to spend that time	i limel = to spend the night
Vehicle	to travel by	i beivu = to go by car

Some words, especially locations, qualities, and abstract nouns, don't have a fixed meaning when used as a verb. This is deliberate.

i bo could mean to be at home, to go home, to enter. i tohpu could mean to feel sad, to act sad, to express sadness. Think of it as the unmarked, general, or poetic option. You may choose it when the specific reading is clear from context, when it doesn't matter, or when you want the word to carry more than one resonance at once.

When you do want to be specific, the tools are already there:

i bo — location as verb

hay en bo	→ she is in the house
hay i anvu jetai bo	→ she goes direction the house
hay i bortāl en bo	→ she enters the house
hay i bo-anvu	→ she house-goes
hay i bo-bortāl	→ she house-enters
hay i bo e falen	→ she houses/shelters a kid

i tohpu — quality as verb

a hay a tohpu	→ she is sad (copula)
hay i davio no tohpu	→ she becomes sad
hay i tohpu-davio	→ she sad-becomes
hay i ciudon e tohpu	→ she shows sadness
hay i tohpu-anye	→ she sad-acts
hay i tohpu e falen	→ she saddens the kid (causative via e)

49. Evidentiality

Oravia has an optional evidential system built on bi. Because bi already marks speaker stance, evidential phrases read as a natural extension of the same system: rather than just commenting, the speaker also notes the source of their knowledge.

The Three Evidential Options

Phrase	Built from	Meaning
bi eosus	bi + eosus (social hearing)	I heard this / reported evidence
bi daeniu	bi + daeniu (witness)	I witnessed this / direct evidence
bi daeta	bi + daeta (inference)	I inferred this / evidential reasoning

bi evidential phrases sit clause-finally, like other bi phrases:

```

hay i anocari bi daeniu
she left – I witnessed this
bi eosus a hay a tohpu
he is sad – I heard this
a bo a anolum hue, bi daeta
the house seems abandoned – I’m inferring this

```

They can also stand alone as a comment on a prior statement:

```
A: hay i faigel. (he got married.)  
B: bi eosus (I heard the same.)
```

Bi evidentials and bi emotional comments

Both use bi, but the words are distinct in meaning and feel. Emotional bi phrases (bi oipoh, bi tohpu, bi oila) express how the speaker feels about the content. Evidential bi phrases express where the knowledge comes from. In practice the two don't conflict and they can be combined:

```
hay i anocari, bi eosus, bi tohpu  
she left – I heard this – how sad
```

50. Grammatical Mistakes

50.1 Constructions

Oravia is a flexible language, and as such, there are not many mistakes one can make. The main ones below are worth knowing because they tend to create ambiguities or miscommunications.

Using the wrong marker

Markers carry the full grammatical weight of a sentence, and swapping markers can make them confusing or change their meaning. For example:

```
I give the big apple to you  
  
i anona e yaltan moaria u run  
V give OBJ big-apple IND-OBJ you ✓  
  
i anona e moaria e run  
V give OBJ apple OBJ you X (e instead of u)
```

Breaking a block

A marker introduces a single block. Modifiers that belong to a phrase must stay inside that block. Moving a modifier out into another position breaks the structure, and the listener cannot determine which block it was meant to belong to.

I give the big apple to you

i anona e yaltan moaria u run

[V give] [OBJ big apple] [IND-OBJ you] ✓

i anona e moaria u run yaltan

[V give] [OBJ apple] [IND-OBJ you] big X (big pulled out of OBJ block)

Modifier after what it modifies

Within any block, modifiers always come before what they modify. A modifier that follows its head creates ambiguity about which word it belongs to and changes its meaning.

I give a big fortune to you

i anona e yaltan yunmir u run

V give OBJ big wealth IND-OBJ you ✓

i anona e yunmir yaltan u run

V give OBJ wealth big IND-OBJ you X (modifier after head, reads as "the wealthy big [person?]")

Stacking verbs without i

Verb stacking requires i before each verb in the chain. Without the second i, the second element reads as a noun rather than a verb, and the sentence changes meaning.

I can go

i do i anvu

V can V go ✓

i do anvu

V can go X (i missing before second verb)

Using ca in a direct question

Ce introduces questions. Ca introduces relative clauses and clause connectors. Using a "ca" word in a direct question reads as an unfinished clause rather than a question.

```
Where are you?

cedom run?
where you?    ✓

cadom run?
where you     X    (connector form used instead of question form)
```

These are the main mistakes that may create issues. The focus is to avoid miscommunication and ambiguity, not to worry about being "grammatically correct". In general, if the listener understands you, you are speaking Oravia correctly.

50.2 Common patterns for English speakers

In the next two subsections, we will break down common transferences from English and Romance to Oravia. I focus on these two backgrounds because they are very dominant in the auxlang community. When people learn a new language, they tend to transfer characteristics of their own. The main goal of these two subsections is to be mindful of some common transferences that may confuse speakers of other backgrounds and/or shift Oravia from an international language to one that prioritizes Germanic-Romance intuitions.

These are the most common English patterns that transfer into Oravia:

Instrument as companionship

English uses "with" for both company and instrument. Oravia separates these. Su marks companionship and addition; anja marks the tool or means by which something is done.

```
I eat with a fork

i mo anja jadun
V eat INSTR fork    ✓

i jadun
V fork              ✓
```

```
i mo su jadun
V eat AND/WITH fork X (companionship, not instrument)
```

The copula

English always uses a verb for "to be". Oravia's copula uses a on both sides with no verb at all. Both the subject and the predicate take the subject marker.

```
I am tall

a nim a yalen
SUBJ I PRED tired ✓

i yalen nim
V tall I X
```

Manner and degree

English uses "how" for both manner and degree. Oravia keeps these separate. Cenon asks in what way something is done; cene asks to what extent. "How sad are you?" is a question about degree, not about method.

```
How sad are you?

cene tohpu a run?
how-degree sad PRED you? ✓

cenon tohpu a run?
how-manner sad PRED you? X (this means "in which way are you sad?")
```

If, whether, and if-then

English "if" covers three distinct situations that Oravia separates:

- . Daehun is for real-world cause and effect.
- . Iliciu is for hypothetical and counterfactual scenarios.

. *la dou* is for indirect questions about whether something is the case.

Using *daehun* for all three flattens a distinction the grammar is built to preserve, and confuses listeners into thinking an "if-then" complement is coming.

I don't know if she left

i ilianum ia dou hay i anocari

V know-not whether she V left ✓

i ilianum daehun hay i anocari

V know-not if-then she V left X (listeners will expect a "then" continuation)

Aspect as tense

Applying *-ar* or *-is* to every verb in a narrative removes its ability to mark actual completion or sequence.

Yesterday, I drank coffee

litamar, nim i mo e mogali

yesterday I V drink OBJ coffee ✓ (bare, natural)

litamar, nim i moar e mogali

yesterday I V drink-COMP OBJ coffee X (listeners will expect a second, later action)

The rule is:

- . Use bare verb form in general
- . Use *-ar* when you want to specify an action has been completed or happened/will happen before another action
- . Use *-is* when you want to specify an action will yet to start or happened/will happen after another action

Compound nouns without *-a*

The *-a* suffix on the first element of a compound signals that the two words are forming a single concept rather than an adjective modifying a noun.

```
yaltana miau  
big-cat = tiger, lion
```

```
yaltan miau  
a big cat = a description of the cat
```

50.2 Common Patterns for Romance Speakers

The same principle applies here. If Oravia absorbs Romance grammar through its speakers, it will confuse speakers of other backgrounds, and be farther from its aim of being international and start reflecting a particular language family. The patterns below are the most common transfers from languages like Spanish, Italian, French, and Portuguese.

De for possession

In Oravia, *de* marks origin and belonging in a broad sense, so using it with personal pronouns read as "from" rather than a possessive relation. Instead, use the *-e* suffix.

haye bo	[her house]	✓
de hay bo	[from she house]	X

Adjective after the noun

In most Romance languages adjectives commonly follow the noun. In Oravia all modifiers come before what they modify, without exception. This applies to single adjectives, compound modifiers, and possessives alike.

yaltan yunmir	[large fortune]	✓
yunmir yaltan	[rich big person]	X (this has a different meaning than was intended)

Gender

Oravia's *-jor* and *-jal* suffixes exist for disambiguation when gender genuinely matters. Carrying Romance intuition into Oravia adds gender marking where the language intentionally leaves it absent, and makes the language feel more gendered than it is designed to be.

Reflexive verbs by habit

Romance languages have many verbs that require a reflexive pronoun. In Oravia, *elihei* exclusively marks reflexive relationships where the subject acts on itself. Using Romance construction here may confuse speakers of other languages.

The pot broke

o e mamol i tinen

EMPH OBJ pot V break ✓

a mamol e elihei i tinen

SUBJ pot OBJ self V break X (pot not as the subject
breaking itself)

Stacking *ca*

Romance languages tend to stack multiple subordinate clauses (e.g., using "*que*"). Two embedded *ca* clauses are usually fine; beyond that, restructuring or rephrasing often reads more easily in Oravia.

Reference

51. How the Vocabulary Works

51.1 The Building Block System

Oravia's 800 words are largely built from 260 syllable-meaning associations called building blocks. These blocks are divided into clusters, subclusters, and roots. Once you have internalized them, you may be able to decode unfamiliar words on sight, learn words much faster, and recognize patterns across the entire vocabulary. The system is designed so that vocabulary does not need to be memorized word by word. Every word reflects its meaning in its structure.

There are three kinds of building blocks. Clusters signal the semantic domain of a word. Subclusters refine the domain. Roots create conceptual links between words in different clusters.

51.2 Clusters

A cluster is the opening sound or sounds of a word. It signals the broad semantic domain the word belongs to. There are approximately 48 clusters. Every word beginning with *MO* belongs to the domain of food and eating. Every word beginning with *VA*

belongs to the body's vital systems. Every word beginning with EL belongs to the domain of wonder and virtue.

This means the very first sound of an Oravia word always tells you something about what that word is about.

A few examples across different domains:

AN	action and movement
BO	home interior (rooms, furniture, structure)
FA	family (roles, relationships, partnership)
IL	inquiry and knowledge (cognition, uncertainty)
LI	time (units, clock, seasons)
MO	food and eating
TO	suffering and distress
VA	body vitals and core systems
YA	objective qualities (size, texture, physical characteristics)

The full cluster list, with subclusters, is in the following section (§52). The opening sound alone covers a large portion of what any unfamiliar word might mean.

51.3 Subclusters

Clusters have between 0-4 subclusters, typically signaled by the third letter. Subclusters refine the domain.

The AN cluster (action and movement) illustrates this clearly:

AN	action and movement in general
ANE	static actions: rest, remain, stop, stay
ANI	movement toward: arrive, come, bring, attract
ANO	movement away: leave, depart, push, send

The word anifi belongs to ANI (toward), so even without knowing the root, a reader knows it involves approach. Anocari belongs to ANO (away), so it involves departure. The subcluster orients the reader directionally before the root is parsed.

51.4 Roots

When you take the (sub)cluster out of a word, what is left is the root. Roots carry consistent meaning, and crucially the same root can appear across multiple clusters, creating conceptual links between words in different domains.

A root encountered in one cluster will carry a recognizable relational meaning when it appears in another.

For example, take the root LEM (to remain):

anelem

ANE (static movement) + LEM (remain) = to remain in place

beilem

BEI (vehicles) + LEM (remain) = station, stop (where vehicles stay)

Some roots are very common and appear in many clusters. Others are more local. The principle holds throughout: when you learn a root in one word, you gain partial knowledge of every word that carries it.

51.5 How Words Are Built

The standard pattern:

(sub)cluster + root = word

From there, several patterns extend the system further.

Compounds are two or more words that together name a single concept rather than describing one thing with an adjective. The first word takes the suffix -a to signal that it is part of a compound rather than a free modifier (see §22.1)

Hyphenated forms join two words for fine-grained or expressive meaning, creating a reading that neither word carries alone. Ilofun-vardei (hesitant-look, to peek with doubt) and toului-asfe (tired-stop, to give up from exhaustion) are examples. The hyphen signals conceptual fusion rather than a modification relationship (see §)

Imported words use an apostrophe prefix to signal that the word does not come from the core vocabulary: 'Italia, 'Nihongo, scientific species names. These never enter the permanent vocabulary. The apostrophe tells the reader this is not a core Oravia word (see §22.2)

51.6 Decoding New Words

Given an unfamiliar word, three steps will usually get you to the meaning or close to it.

First, identify the cluster. The opening sound or sounds tell you the semantic domain. Check the first two letters, then the third to identify whether a subcluster applies.

Second, identify the root. Subtract the cluster from the word. What remains is the root. If you have encountered this root before, its meaning carries over to a new context.

Third, combine. Cluster domain plus root meaning gives you the approximate reading. This will not always be exact, but it puts you in the right territory.

Two examples:

vardei

VA = body parts

VAR = face (subcluster)

-dei = sight, look

vardei = eye

i vardei = to see, to look

boemo

BO = home interior

BOE = house rooms (subcluster)

-mo = food (from MO cluster)

boemo = house-room-food = kitchen

When learning or encountering words, keeping syllable-meaning associations in mind will do more than memorizing individual words.

52. Cluster Reference Table

Approximately 48 main clusters organize the Oravia vocabulary. Each cluster is identified by its opening sound(s). Words beginning with those sounds belong to that cluster's semantic domain. Subclusters (shown indented) refine the domain further.

Sound	Domain	Key subclusters
AN	action / movement	ANE static · ANI toward · ANO away · APA physical · AS involuntary body · ASE affectionate contact · ASI orifice · ASU involuntary vocal
BE	travel	BEI vehicles
BO	home interior	BOE house spaces · BON furniture · BOR structure · BOS hygiene fixtures
CIU	creative products	—

C0	communication	COU written communication
DA	evaluation / knowledge	DAE epistemic · DAN emphasis
D0	regulations	DOH enforcement
EL	wonder / virtue	ELA religious · ELE self-expansion · ELI virtue · ELO prosocial
E0	social	EOD social interactions · EOM events & gatherings
FA	family	FAE gender · FAI partnership/marriage · FAL young ones
GA	comparison / ranking	GAN ranking · GAO value assessment
GE	finances	GEL trading
HE	fiction tropes	HEH antagonist · HEI protagonist · HEO background/setting
IL	inquiry / knowledge	ILA sharing information · ILI cognition · ILO uncertainty
JA	tools	JAH cutting tools · JAS gripping & fastening tools
JE	geometrics / space	JEN location · JEO geometric positions
J0	materials	JOL material types
LE	environment / land	LEA landscape · LEI plants
LI	time	LITE clock time · LUN seasons
LU	weather / atmosphere / outside	LUN seasons
MA	cooking / food preparation	MAE tubers & grains · MAL bread & dairy · MAS spices
MI	larger animals	MIO wild animals
M0	food / eating	MOA fruits · MOL food containers
MU	smaller animals	MUH flying animals / birds
NE	quantifiers / gradation	—
N0	function words	NOR relation to reference
OI	fun / excitement	—
OM	music / sound	—
P0	components / matter	POA chemical · POH energy · POI liquids

RA	society	RAI governance · RAN media & discourse · RAS culture
R0	knowledge / learning	ROE formal education · ROU written knowledge
SE	machines / technology	SEL coding · SEM systems
SI	processes	—
SI0	games / play	—
TI	harm / damage	TIU types of harm
T0	suffering / distress	TOH emotional · TOS interpersonal · TOU physical depletion
TU	conflict	TUL crash · TUM weapons
VA	core / body vitals	VAN limbs · VAR face · VEI health issues · VEL medical treatment
VI	interior body	VIR organs
V0	hygiene / personal care	VON external body surfaces · VOS grooming actions
WA	water	—
WI	geographical orientation	WIL human-made geography · WIM natural geography
YA	objective qualities	YAH texture · YAL size
YE	clothing & fabric	YES garments
Y0	colors	—
YU	subjective qualities	YUN personal characteristics

Even without knowing a specific word, the opening sound gives the domain. Subclusters narrow it further. The full vocabulary of ~800 words is distributed across these clusters, with a total of ~260 building syllable-meaning associations.

53. Quick Reference

Marker / Word	Function
a	subject marker
i	verb marker
e	direct object marker

u	indirect object marker (to / for)
o	focus, emphasis; + i = imperative; + e = passive
en	time or location (at / in / on)
de	of, from
-e	possessive suffix on pronouns
-jor / -jal	feminine / masculine suffix
-ar / -is	completed / prospective aspect
-um	negation
-a	compound modifier suffix
hai / hue	agent, role / recipient, resultant state
ca / caei / cadom / cali / caora	connectors: that, who, where, when, because
canon / cane	connectors: how (manner) / as (degree) as
ce / cei / cedom / celi / ceora	question words: what, who, where, when, why
cemir / cenon / cene	question words: how many / how (manner) / how (degree)
su / dou / mai / eta	and / or / but / therefore
ho / no	opposite / like-as-similar to; nominal complement
ga / gaomem / anodu	comparative / equality / superlative
bi	speaker comment
ne	gradation prefix (+ number)
(da)sora	purpose, in order to
jetai	direction, toward
anja	instrument, by means of
lor	benefit marker, for someone's sake (used after u)
ciude	about
elihei / rein	self / each other
iliciu / daehun	counterfactual / factual conditional
lirul	habit
notam / notor	first event / second event

yadetu / tonan / lar / lis	finally / suddenly / once (past) / sometime in the future
noli / noi	now / here